

QUEUE

1. Passage anchor

> “I had just stepped out of a **queue** when I noticed a little girl crying outside a souvenir shop.”

Passage meaning

queue = a line of people waiting for something

隊伍；排隊的人龍

Here, the narrator has just left a line of people waiting for a ride or attraction at the theme park.

Practice

1. We waited in a long **queue** for the roller coaster.

我們排在長長的**隊伍**中等候乘坐過山車。

2. The **queue** outside the ride moved slowly.

遊樂設施外的**人龍**移動得很慢。

Core meanings of QUEUE

2. queue — line of people waiting

As a noun:

= line of people waiting in order for something

隊伍；人龍；排隊的人

Examples

1. There was a long **queue** at the ticket counter.

售票處有一條很長的**隊伍**。

2. We joined the **queue** outside the restaurant.

我們加入了餐廳外的**人龍**。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. queue — line of vehicles

= line of cars, buses, etc. waiting or moving very slowly

****車龍；排隊等候的車輛****

Examples

1. A long ****queue of cars**** formed outside the tunnel.

隧道外形成了一條長長的****車龍****。

2. We were stuck in a ****queue**** for nearly an hour.

我們困在****車龍****中接近一小時。

Same underlying waiting-in-order concept, but a useful transport application.

Verb: wait in line

4. queue — wait in a line

As a verb:

= stand or wait in a line for something

****排隊；輪候****

Examples

1. People ****queued**** for tickets.

人們為買票而****排隊****。

2. We had to ****queue**** for half an hour.

我們要****排隊等候****半小時。

5. queue for something

= wait in a line to receive, enter, buy, use, etc. something

****排隊等候.....****

Examples

1. Visitors ****queued for**** the new ride.

遊客****排隊等候****乘坐新的遊樂設施。

2. Hundreds of people ****queued for**** tickets.

數百人****排隊購票****。

6. queue to do something

= wait in line in order to do something

****排隊等候做某事****

Examples

1. People ****queued to enter**** the building.

人們****排隊等候進入****大樓。

2. Fans ****queued to meet**** the singer.

歌迷****排隊等候與****歌手見面。

Queue up

7. queue up — form/wait in a line

= form a queue or wait in one

****排隊；排成一列****

Examples

1. Everyone ****queued up**** outside the entrance.

大家都在入口外****排隊****。

2. Children ****queued up**** for ice cream.

孩子們****排隊****買雪糕。

Very common, especially in BrE.

8. queue something up — arrange for later action

= place something in order so that it will be played, processed, shown, etc. later

****把.....加入等候序列；排好等待處理 / 播放****

Examples

1. I ****queued up**** several songs for the journey.

我把幾首歌****排進播放序列****，準備旅途中播放。

2. The system **queued up** the next task automatically.
系統自動把下一項工作**加入等候處理的序列**。

This bridges the everyday and computing senses.

Computing / technology

9. queue — ordered list waiting for processing

= collection of tasks, data, requests, jobs, messages, etc. waiting to be handled in order
佇列；**等候序列**

Examples

1. Your request has been added to the **queue**.
你的請求已加入**等候佇列**。
2. Several jobs are still in the processing **queue**.
還有幾項工作留在處理**佇列**中。

Major modern technical sense.

10. queue — computer data structure

In computing:

= data structure in which items are typically removed in the same order in which they were added
佇列

Often summarized as:

FIFO — first in, first out
先進先出

Examples

1. The program stores requests in a **queue**.
程式把請求儲存在一個**佇列**中。
2. A basic **queue** processes the oldest item first.
基本**佇列**會先處理最早加入的項目。

11. job queue

= list of computer or system jobs waiting to be processed

****工作佇列；任務等候序列****

Examples

1. The job was placed in the ****job queue****.
這項工作被放進****工作佇列****。
2. The server processes tasks from the ****job queue****.
伺服器從****工作佇列****中處理任務。

12. print queue

= list of documents waiting to be printed

****列印佇列；列印等候序列****

Examples

1. The document is stuck in the ****print queue****.
文件卡在****列印佇列****中。
2. I cleared the ****print queue**** and tried again.
我清除了****列印佇列****後再試一次。

13. message queue

= system/list holding messages until they can be delivered or processed

****訊息佇列****

Examples

1. The application sends events through a ****message queue****.
應用程式透過****訊息佇列****傳送事件。
2. Messages remain in the ****queue**** until they are processed.
訊息會留在****佇列****中，直至被處理。

14. priority queue

= queue in which items are processed according to priority rather than simply arrival order

****優先佇列****

Examples

1. Urgent tasks go into a ****priority queue****.
緊急任務會進入****優先佇列****。
2. A ****priority queue**** may process high-priority items first.
****優先佇列****可能會先處理優先級較高的項目。

Useful technical compound.

Telecommunications / customer service

15. call queue

= list of callers waiting for an agent or service

****來電等候佇列；電話輪候隊列****

Examples

1. Your call has been placed in a ****queue****.
你的來電已進入****等候隊列****。
2. There are ten callers ahead of you in the ****call queue****.
****來電輪候隊列****中有十人在你之前。

16. waiting queue / virtual queue

= system that holds a person's place without requiring them to stand physically in line

****虛擬排隊；輪候系統****

Examples

1. The theme park uses a ****virtual queue**** for popular rides.
主題樂園為熱門遊樂設施設置****虛擬排隊系統****。

2. We joined the **virtual queue** through the app.

我們透過應用程式加入**虛擬輪候隊列**。

Especially relevant to modern theme parks and online booking systems.

High-value expressions

17. join the queue

= enter the end of a line of people waiting

加入隊伍；排到隊尾

Examples

1. We **joined the queue** for the ride.

我們**加入了乘坐遊樂設施的隊伍**。

2. Please **join the queue** at the back.

請到後面**排隊**。

18. stand / wait in a queue

= remain in a line while waiting

排隊等候

Examples

1. We **stood in the queue** for forty minutes.

我們**排隊等候**了四十分鐘。

2. Nobody enjoys **waiting in a queue**.

沒有人喜歡**排隊等候**。

19. at the front of the queue

= first or near first in a waiting line

在隊伍前面；排在最前

Examples

1. She was ****at the front of the queue****.

她****排在隊伍最前面****。

2. We arrived early and ended up near ****the front of the queue****.

我們很早到，所以最後排在****隊伍前列****。

20. at the back of the queue

= last or near last in a waiting line

****在隊伍後面；排在最後****

Examples

1. He went to ****the back of the queue****.

他走到****隊伍最後面****。

2. New arrivals must join ****the back of the queue****.

新來的人必須排在****隊尾****。

Jump the queue

21. jump the queue

Especially BrE:

= unfairly go ahead of other people who have been waiting longer

****插隊；打尖****

Examples

1. Don't ****jump the queue****.

不要****插隊****。

2. People became angry when he tried to ****jump the queue****.

他試圖****插隊****時，大家都生氣了。

Very high-value expression.

22. queue-jumping

= act of unfairly moving ahead of others in a queue

****插隊；打尖行為****

Examples

1. ****Queue-jumping**** is not allowed.

不准****插隊****。

2. The argument started over ****queue-jumping****.

那場爭執因****插隊行為****而起。

Figurative waiting order

23. in the queue for something

= waiting in an ordered sequence for an opportunity, service, promotion, etc.

****排隊等候；輪候獲得某事****

Examples

1. Several projects are ****in the queue for approval****.

有幾個專案正在****輪候審批****。

2. Her request is next ****in the queue****.

她的請求是****下一個輪候處理的****。

This is an abstract extension of literal waiting.

QUEUED / QUEUING

24. queued

= placed in a queue and waiting

****已排隊的；已加入等候序列的****

Examples

1. The download is ****queued****.

下載工作已****加入等候序列****。

2. Three tasks are ****queued**** for processing.

有三項任務****排隊等候處理****。

25. queuing / queueing

Both spellings occur.

= act or process of waiting or arranging things in a queue

****排隊；輪候；佇列處理****

Examples

1. We spent an hour ****queuing****.

我們花了一小時****排隊****。

2. The system uses ****queueing**** to manage requests.

系統利用****佇列機制****管理請求。

****Queuing**** is very common; ****queueing**** is also accepted, especially where retaining the full word makes the technical relation clearer.

Regional difference

26. queue vs line

BrE

****queue**** is very common.

> stand in a queue

> ****排隊****

AmE

****line**** is generally more common for people physically waiting.

> stand in line

> ****排隊****

Compare:

> BrE: We queued for tickets.

> AmE: We stood in line for tickets.

Both are understood internationally, but the preference differs.

Key contrasts

27. queue vs line

queue

= people/things waiting in an ordered sequence

輪候隊伍；佇列

line

= broader word for a row, mark, boundary, telephone connection, written line, etc.

So every queue has order, while **line** has many meanings unrelated to waiting.

28. queue vs row

queue

= people/things waiting one after another

排隊隊伍

row

= people/things arranged side by side or in a straight line, not necessarily waiting

一排；一列

Compare:

> queue outside a cinema

> 電影院外的排隊人龍

> row of seats

> 一排座位

29. queue vs wait

wait

= remain until something happens

等待

queue

= wait specifically as part of an ordered line

****排隊等候****

You can wait without being in a queue.

30. queue vs stack — computing

In basic computer science:

****queue****

= usually ****first in, first out****

****先進先出佇列****

****stack****

= usually ****last in, first out****

****後進先出堆疊****

A useful core technical distinction.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****queue**** is:

****things or people waiting in an ordered sequence****

From this develops:

Passage

queue for a theme-park ride

→ ****排隊等候的人龍****

Transport

queue of cars

→ ****車龍****

Verb

queue for tickets

→ ****排隊購票****

Abstract processing

requests in a queue

→ **等候處理的請求**

Computing

data queue

→ **佇列**

Printing

print queue

→ **列印佇列**

Customer service

call queue

→ **電話輪候隊列**

Online systems

virtual queue

→ **虛擬排隊系統**

The concept remains unusually stable:

> **first there → waits → eventually gets processed/served**

So this is a good example of **one central semantic concept extending from physical waiting into digital processing**, rather than many unrelated senses.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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queue — people	按先後次序等候的人群；隊伍 / 人龍
queue — vehicles	排隊或緩慢前進的一列車輛；車龍
queue — verb	排成一隊等候；排隊 / 輪候
queue for something	排隊等候取得、進入、使用某物
queue to do something	排隊等候做某事
queue up — people	排成一列 / 排隊等候
queue something up	把某物加入等待播放、處理等的序列
queue — processing	等候被處理的工作、請求、訊息等序列

queue — computing	按特定次序儲存和處理項目的佇列	
job queue	等候系統處理的工作 / 任務佇列	
print queue	等候列印的文件佇列	
message queue	等候傳送或處理的訊息佇列	
priority queue	按優先級決定處理次序的優先佇列	
call queue	等候客服人員接聽的來電隊列	
virtual queue	不必實際站著排隊的虛擬輪候系統	
join the queue	加入等候隊伍 / 排到隊尾	
front of the queue	隊伍前面 / 輪候次序最前	
back of the queue	隊伍後面 / 隊尾	
jump the queue	不按先後次序而插隊 / 打尖	
queue-jumping	插隊行為	
in the queue for something	正按次序輪候某機會、服務或處理	
queued	已加入隊伍 / 等候序列，等待處理的	
queuing / queueing	排隊、輪候或使用佇列處理的行為 / 過程	

Passage recap

> “I had just stepped out of a **queue** when I noticed a little girl crying outside a souvenir shop.”

Here:

queue = **a line of people waiting in order**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **隊伍**

* **人龍**

* contextually: **排隊等候遊樂設施的人群**

Natural contextual translation:

我剛從排隊的人龍中走出來，就注意到紀念品店外有個小女孩在哭。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

queue

= **a line of people waiting for something in order**

隊伍；排隊的人龍

The crucial learner contrast is regional:

> **BrE: queue**

> → 排隊 / 隊伍

> **AmE: line / stand in line**

> → 排隊 / 隊伍

But in computing, **queue** becomes especially important:

> **print queue**

> → 列印佇列

> **message queue**

> → 訊息佇列

> **job queue**

> → 工作佇列

So the physical and technical meanings share the same underlying concept: **items wait in an ordered sequence until their turn comes**.